

Chapter 8

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 8: Media, Technology, and Cultural Representation

Objective: To help students understand the role of media and technology in shaping cultural perceptions, the impact of digital globalization, the issues of misrepresentation and stereotyping, and how to create positive content to promote cultural understanding through interactive tasks, critical thinking, and creative engagement.

Part 1: Media’s Role in Shaping Perceptions – Analyzing Influence

Instructions: Media, including movies, news, and social media, shapes how we view cultures, as discussed in the chapter. Choose one type of media (e.g., a movie, news story, or social media trend) that you’ve encountered recently portraying a specific culture. Fill in the table below with details about its portrayal and impact. Use examples from the chapter (like Bollywood’s depiction of Indian values or Hollywood’s stereotypes) to guide your analysis.

Media Type & Example (e.g., Movie: The Big Bang Theory)	Culture Portrayed (e.g., Indian)	How Was the Culture Shown? (Positive/Negative Aspects)	Impact on Your Perception (Did it reinforce or challenge your views?)

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Culture Portrayed (e.g., Indian)

How Was the Culture Shown? (Positive/Negative Aspects)

Impact on Your Perception (Did it reinforce or challenge your views?)

Quick Question: How do you think media portrayals, like the one you analyzed, influence how teens treat classmates or friends from that culture? (2-3 sentences)

Part 2: Digital Globalization – Exploring Connections

Instructions: The chapter discusses how the internet connects cultures through trends and content. Think of one global cultural trend or piece of content (e.g., a K-pop song, an Indian festival video, or a recipe tutorial) you've seen online. Describe it below, and answer how it helped you learn about or connect with that culture. Reference the chapter's ideas on cultural exchange or digital divides.

Chosen Trend/Content: _____ **Description:** (What is it, and where did you see it?)

Learning/Connection: (What did you learn about the culture, or how did it make you feel connected?)

Follow-Up Question: Considering digital divides mentioned in the chapter, do you think this online content represents the whole culture, or might some voices be missing due to lack of internet access? Why? (2-3 sentences)

Part 3: Misrepresentation and Stereotyping in Media – Critical Thinking

Instructions: Media often misrepresents cultures or uses stereotypes, as outlined in the chapter. Pick one example of a stereotype or misrepresentation you've seen in media (e.g., Hollywood's portrayal of Arabs as villains or Indian TV's take on regional groups). Describe it, explain why it's problematic using chapter concepts, and suggest one way to correct this portrayal.

Chosen Example: _____ **Description of Stereotype/Misrepresentation:** (What did the media show, and how was it portrayed?)

Why It's Problematic: (How does it harm or mislead, based on chapter ideas like real-world impact?)

Suggested Correction: (How could media show this culture more accurately or fairly?)

Reflection: How has learning about media stereotypes changed how you view content or interact with people from stereotyped groups? (2-3 sentences)

Part 4: Creating Positive Content – Be a Cultural Creator

Instructions: The chapter encourages teens to create content that promotes cultural understanding. Choose one idea from the chapter (e.g., showcasing real stories, collaborating across cultures, or challenging stereotypes) and design a mini "content plan" for a social media post, video, or blog that celebrates a culture (yours or another's). Include two specific steps to make it authentic and impactful. Then, answer the reflection question.

Chosen Idea: _____ **Content Plan Title/Theme:** (e.g., "Diwali Traditions Vlog" or "Busting Indian Nerd Stereotype")

Action Steps:

- **Step 1:** (What will you create or include, and how will you ensure authenticity?)
- **Step 2:** (How will you share it or engage others to spread cultural understanding?)

Reflection: Why do you think creating positive content like this can make a difference in how people view cultures online or in real life? (2-3 sentences)

Part 5: Creative Task – "Media Makeover Storyboard"

Instructions: Imagine you're redesigning a piece of media (a movie scene, news story, or social media post) that misrepresented a culture, as discussed in the chapter. Create a short storyboard (or describe it in words) for a 3-panel remake that corrects the portrayal with a more authentic or positive view. Include a cultural challenge or stereotype and how it's addressed. Use the space below for your sketch or description, and give it a title.

Storyboard Sketch or Description:

- **Panel 1:** (Original misrepresentation or setting)
- **Panel 2:** (Challenge or stereotype being confronted)
- **Panel 3:** (Positive, authentic resolution or portrayal)

Title of Story: _____

